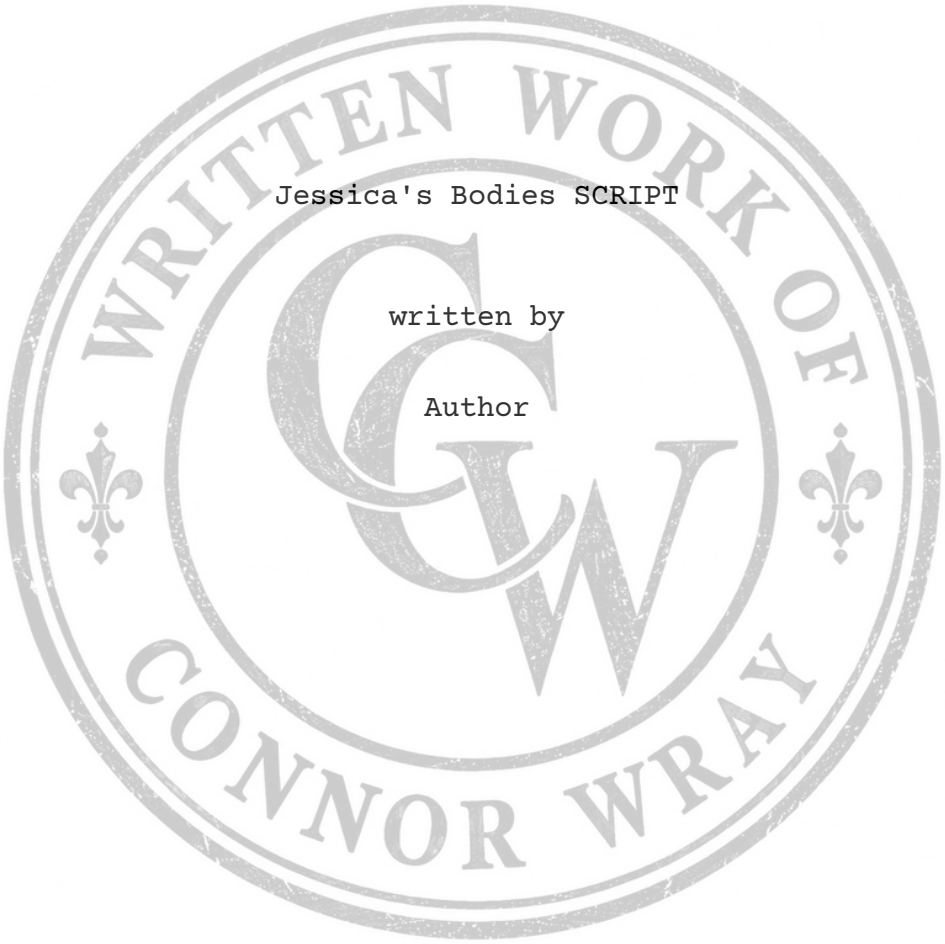
Jessica's Bodies SCRIPT

written by

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Address
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INT. COLLEGE APARTMENT - NIGHT

Tampa - 1990

DIVE - NIRVANA is playing out of a CD player surrounded by red solo cups in "beer pong" formation, a small army of empty beer 12-packs, and a couple bags of weed.

The song plays pitifully into the barely responsive remnants of a house party.

JESSICA is going out on a high note - 20 years old, wearing a short sleeve shirt over a long sleeve shirt with brown hair done up in feathered bangs. She takes one of the red solo cups and downs whatever is in it - she grimaces at the taste but drinks anyway.

HAILEY is barely awake on the couch leaning against KIETH who already has his head laid back with his eyes closed. EVAN is awkwardly sitting on the opposite side of the couch - alert and sober.

HAILEY
(groggily)
Girl, don't drink that, Matty brought Falstaff beer, that shit is nasty.

JESSICA
(coughing)
Yeah, it really is.

HAILEY
Jess, just give me like 10 minutes and I'll go set up the air mattress for you.

JESSICA
No.

HAILEY
You're right, I'm gonna need 20.

JESSICA
I mean, no, I'm not staying Hails. I've got an art crit tomorrow at 9.

EVAN
Jessica, you're not going to drive, right?

JESSICA
Uh, yeah. I'm going to drive, I need my car to get back.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

JESSICA (CONT'D)
It's like a 15 minute drive - that's like an hour walk.

HAILEY
You're not even an art major, why do you care?

JESSICA
I want to graduate - I need to get good grades for classes I don't care about to do that. And so do you.

Hailey groans and curls into Keith as is physically wounded by Jessica's words.

KEITH
Sounds like a scam.

JESSICA
You do too, Keith.

Keith waves Jessica off.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Where's my purse?

Jessica stumbles around looking for her bag.

Hailey and Keith protest from the couch.

HAILEY
Jessica, hold on, just let me set up the air mattress.

JESSICA
Hailey, I'm not even that drunk, I'll be fine. Where is my purse??

Evan spots Jessica's purse next to the couch and picks it up - Jessica notices. Immediately, Jessica becomes uncomfortable. She composes herself and pretends to be happy.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Evan, you found it! Thank you so much, can you just hand it to me?

Evan hesitates.

EVAN
Jessica, I can drive you home, I don't mind.

WRITTEN WORK OF SONWRAY

Jessica's smile drops. She looks over to Hailey and Keith for help but they're both exhausted with their eyes shut.

JESSICA
Oh, Evan...you're so sweet, but I don't want to put you out of your way. And then I'd still be out of a car and I wouldn't have a way to get to class in the morning. It's just too much work.

EVAN
It's not that far out of the way - and really, I don't mind. I can even drive you in the morning if you don't have anyone else who can do it.

KEITH
(calling over to them)
Yeah, Jess, just let Evan drive you back - he didn't drink anything.

HAILEY
(whispers to Keith)
No, dumbass, that's why I told her to just stay over.

Jessica sighs, running out of ways to be polite.

JESSICA
It'll just be easier if I just go myself, really. Give me my purse?

Evan slowly hands Jessica her purse back. Jessica snatches her bag back and offers a brief smile before walking past Hailey and Keith to the door.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Thanks for the party guys, great stuff as always. I'll see you guys sometime next week.

Jessica wastes no time rushing out of the house.

Evan stands quietly, watching the door - a look of unshakable worry on his face.

EXT. HIGHWAY - NIGHT

Wheels of a chevy edge over the yellow line as it cruises down the highway.

A very tired Jessica drives the truck along an almost entirely empty night road as "How Am I Supposed To Live Without You" by Michael Bolton blares on the radio.

Jessica slaps herself to try and stay awake but her eyes continue to flutter open and shut - open and shut.

For 5 seconds Jessica's eyes remain shut. When she opens them again, it's too late.

SCREEN GOES BLACK.

We hear the sound of a car crashing against a barrier and tumbling over a few times.

Police sirens break through the silence.

INT. BINARY LABS - NIGHT

In a blurry edged circle in a dark screen we are focused on a petri dish full of small green bubbles that begin branching off of themselves and forming more bubbles.

Taking the place of the petri dish is a HUMAN EYE looking through a magnified lens - blinking and observing.

We see CATHY working in a lab with a microscope and a myriad of fungus samples. She's a woman in her late 20s/early 30s with frizzy brown hair, rectangle glasses, and a white lab coat. She has orange headphones on connected to a Sony Walkman.

The glass wall behind her shows that just about everyone else has gone - the labs all have their lights off except one.

Cathy removes the petri dish and caps it with a lid labeled clearly: **Glomeromycota (Blastospores).**

She sets the petri dish safely with the others before writing down some observations in a notepad. Behind her - the final neighboring light snaps off and we see a fellow scientist walk out of the building.

SCIENTIST
(waving through the window)
Goodnight, Cathy!

Cathy realizes she's left to close up the lab. She sighs and removes her headphones. After a beat, she begins to pack up.

EXT. BINARY LABS PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Cathy walks out alone to a half-lit parking lot with a messenger bag FILLED to the brim. She is no longer dawning a white lab coat and instead is wearing a cyan turtleneck tucked into jeans.

She walks to her simple car that's about 12 years old. Her car is **1 OF 2 CARS LEFT IN THE LOT**, with the other being a **black 1989 Lincoln Town Car.** It's lights are off. Cathy doesn't notice this, gets in her car, and drives away.

We hold on the Lincoln after Cathy leaves the parking lot. After a beat - the Lincoln turns its headlights on and drives after Cathy.

INT. MARV'S VETERAN'S BAR - NIGHT

TURN AROUND the bar to see mostly older men playing pool and sitting and drinking together. We see one makeshift long table of about 8 silver haired veteran women having a "girls night out". About half the people we see are wearing a hat of some kind to represent their service.

The turn ends on the front door where VINCE comes through; an older bald gentleman with a scruffy white beard. He has tired eyes and is wearing a hefty brown leather jacket - an old pilots jacket.

He pays no mind to the other patrons of the bar and instead sets his sights on the currently unoccupied bartender - LOU.

Vince takes a seat at the bar.

VINCE
Busy night, Lou. You holding it down ok?

LOU
Oh yeah, no problem. I got some new blood in the back now washing some dishes. We got a good system where she comes out and makes the fancy drinks when I get tired and I come out and pour the crappy beer when she gets tired.

VINCE
Simple and effective.

LOU
(laughs)
Exactly. So, you're getting crappy beer; what can I pour you?

VINCE
Just Guinness.

Lou grabs a pint glass and begins pouring from the tap.

LOU
It's gonna be bad Guinness.

VINCE
Nobody drinks for the taste, Lou.

LOU
True enough.

Lou hands Vince a full pint.

Vince takes a big sip. Splits the G and goes beyond. In one swig he cuts the pint in half.

Lou is looking at Vince with eyebrows raised - not surprised but impressed.

VINCE
The missing person gig you gave me was easy enough. Overnight work.

LOU
Wife run away from husband?

VINCE
Husband run away from wife, actually. Hiding out in a cabin in Berwidge with a buddy.

LOU
Oh. Affair?

VINCE
Mid-life crisis or something. Watched them both long enough to realize they're both exhausting, one of them was always bound to get exhausted. Told the cops, letting them handle it now.

LOU
So everyone's happy?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

VINCE
(sarcastically)
Always.

Lou smiles and pops the cap off a bottle for a different patron.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Any new work come in?

Lou checks his pockets, missing something. He looks up and shouts at the door leading to the back:

LOU
Clarisse! Can you grab my black book and bring it out here please!

After a moment, a 20-something woman wearing a bar shirt and paint-stained jeans rushes out to hand Lou a tiny black notebook.

CLARISSE
There you go, old man.

LOU
Thank you very much, young woman.

Clarisse smiles and nods to Vince before returning back to work.

Lou flips open the notebook and looks through some pages about halfway in.

LOU (CONT'D)
Eh...not too much right now, some low ballers but not much you'd be interested in.

VINCE
Let me hear them anyway.

LOU
Alright...bail dodger, crack slinger. Bail dodger, pot slinger. Missing person, fiance. Bail dodger, open container. Didn't show up for hearing, pot slinger. Didn't show up for hearing, "public menace"...

VINCE
Public menace? What's that one?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

LOU
Just a fancy way of saying "some kid who does graffiti".

VINCE
I'll take the public menace.

LOU
You sure, Vince? It's just going to be another one-nighter with pissy jerks.

VINCE
If it keeps me busy for a bit, I'll take it.

LOU
Right, gimme one second. I'll grab the file.

Lou disappears for a beat in the back room.

Vince sips his Guinness. Then feels eyes on him. He looks up to see a thin haired man wearing sunglasses and reading a science fiction pocket book titled: "The Planet Wizard".

It looks like the man with glasses has his head tilted in the direction of Vince - not convincingly reading his book.

Vince notes this, keeping his eyes on the man as he flips another page in his book and Vince sips his Guinness again.

Lou returns with a manilla file in his hand labeled "Item 212".

LOU (CONT'D)
Everything you need, Maverick.

VINCE
(chuckles)
Thank you, Lou.

LOU
You need a top-off?

VINCE
No, one and done for me tonight.

LOU
What about "not drinking for the taste"?

VINCE
I'm old, Lou. One is enough for me.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

Lou and Vince share a laugh.

The man wearing sunglasses in the corner looks up at them, watching quietly.

EXT. MARV'S VETERAN'S BAR - NIGHT

Marv walks out to his car, an old 1964 Pontiac. He settles in quietly, turns the car on and sets the folder in the passenger seat before driving away.

As he pulls away from the small strip of street parking just outside of the bar - a **black 1989 Lincoln Town Car** across the street turns its lights on and follows Vince.

EXT. TOWN STREETS - NIGHT

Vince drives back home along mostly empty streets. The Lincoln hangs back a far ways - but Vince glances back in his rearview mirror and notices it.

EXT. HIGHWAY - NIGHT

The black Lincoln is not far behind Cathy - who still has yet to realize its presence.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy arrives at her home, a small condo. She parks her car in the driveway and walks inside.

As Cathy enters the home - we see for a brief second, the black Lincoln slowing to a stop just outside. Cathy doesn't realize this as she shuts the door.

Cathy sets her items down on a nearby chair and walks to the kitchen. She pulls cranberry juice out of the fridge and pours herself a glass.

As she does - **a knock at her door.**

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Vince walks into his house, a small single floor home. He sets the file on the counter by the front door and stands quietly, unmoving in the doorway for a moment.

He slowly reaches over to the counter and slides open a drawer, pulling out a gun and shutting the drawer again.

Vince walks steadily forward into the living room, not making a sound with his steps.

Vince moves next to a bookshelf in the living room and tucks in close to the corner between the wall and the bookshelf - concealing himself in shadow.

A beat...then...

A knock at the door.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy sips from her glass, looking up at the door.

CATHY
Hello?

No response. Cathy sets her glass down and walks to her door. She checks through the peephole and sees nothing - no sign of the black Lincoln.

She opens the door.

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Vince doesn't move. He holds on tight to his gun and waits for any other noise or movement.

Through the window he sees headlights pulling away from his neighborhood street.

Vince carefully walks back to his front door.

He opens it and looks down seeing: **an orange package with a triangle inside a circle labeled on it.** No return address.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy is looking down at the exact same package. She looks around for who might have dropped it off but there is no one out except for a neighbor walking his dog.

Cathy brings the package inside. She sets in on her kitchen counter and inspects it thoroughly. There's nothing but the triangle logo.

She shakes the package and feels around for an outline of its contents. There seems to be one solid brick of an item inside and nothing else.

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Vince has the package set on a coffee table in his living room. He stares at it for a minute before pulling out a switch knife and cutting the package open and dumping the contents out on the table.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

A plain black flip phone.

CATHY
What the fuck?

It begins ringing.

Cathy jumps, startled.

CATHY (CONT'D)
Oh, absolutely not.

Cathy opens a drawer and grabs a pair of tongs. She picks up the ringing phone with the tongs and walks it over to a trashcan in the corner.

As she approaches, it stops ringing and her panic subsides.

Cathy jumps in surprise again, dropping the phone from the tongs.

Cautiously, Cathy leans down and picks up the phone, flipping it open.

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Vince watches the phone buzz and ring on the counter for a while. He lets it go until it stops ringing.

Once the ringing starts again, he opens the phone, briefly inspects it: nothing but an ordinary flip phone.

He puts the phone to his ear and says nothing.

PHONE VOICE
Vincent Foresythe. This is Agent Frost calling on behalf of Delta Green. You've been invited to a night at the opera.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy has the phone to her ear.

PHONE VOICE
Catherine Prennick. This is Agent Frost calling on behalf of Delta Green. You've been invited to a night at the opera.

Cathy is shocked and confused. She stutters to get words out.

CATHY
Ok, I have some questions first...Frost? How did you get my information? Who dropped this package off at my house? Who are you actually because "Frost" is a fake as hell name? Is "Opera" codeword for some kind of trafficking ring, because hard pass. And what is "Delta Green"?

PHONE VOICE
Every question you have can be answered tomorrow morning: 11am, at Trio's Diner. I'll be alone, I'll be outside, I'll be unarmed. If you choose to come you will be helping some very desperate people in need - if you don't, we'll find someone else who will. Now please, get rid of this phone.

CATHY
Wait, why won't you answer my questions now? What is this James Bond shit?

The opposite end of the phone clips dead.

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

VINCE
I think I follow. Can you offer up some details so I know this isn't some scam?

Beat.

PHONE VOICE
There have been some unusual happenings in your area and we believe you and another specialist would be right to handle it. You can meet me at Trio's Diner tomorrow at 11am. I'll be alone, I'll be outside, I'll be unarmed. If you choose to come you will be helping some very desperate people in need - if you don't, we'll find someone else who will. Now please, get rid of this phone.

The line goes dead.

Vince checks the phone and realizes the call has ended. Without a seconds hesitation he closes his knife and smashes the phone to bits with the hilt of the knife.

VINCE
11 o clock then.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy looks at the phone in her hand, no less confused than she was before.

CATHY
What the fuck?

EXT. TRIO'S DINER - DAY

We see the lower half of a well-dressed man reading the newspaper that has a back-page article about the recently deceased Jessica Amon.

A waitress brings out a small plate with a small cup filled with espresso to the man. He thanks her and sets the newspaper down.

We see AGENT FROST wearing a full cover white face mask with mirrored aviator sunglasses over the eyes and a black fedora. He peels up the bottom part of the mask to reveal black skin, unscarred or marked - the mask is only for identity concealment - as he sips the espresso.

Frost checks his wrist for the time - 11:14am.

INT. CATHY'S CAR - DAY

Cathy is wearing a disguise that eerily resembles "Carmen San Diego": a large hat, big sunglasses, business formal outfit, and a decorative scarf. She certainly doesn't look like the Cathy we saw previously.

She notices Frost sitting outside - he prominently stands out from the other patrons of the diner but nobody appears to be very put off by him.

Cathy pulls out a cheap disposable yellow camera and clicks 3 pictures of Frost before tucking the camera back in her purse.

She takes a few deep breaths to bring her stress down before stepping out of her car.

EXT. TRIO'S DINER - DAY

Cathy sits across from Frost - they both look like cartoon characters plucked from their show and placed in our world.

Frost raises his espresso cup to her in a "cheers" motion.

FROST
Catherine Prennick.

CATHY
"Agent Frost".

FROST
Well presumed. What can I call you?

CATHY
(thinks of a name on the spot)
Christina Applegate.

FROST
(laughs)
Whatever you say, Christina.

CATHY
Don't laugh. Why shouldn't I use a fake name if this is all so "top secret"?

FROST
Because nobody cares, Christina. Look around. You think anybody has noticed your hat, or my mask?
(MORE)

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FROST (CONT'D)
About 75% of the "secrecy" of this job will take care of itself simply because people won't care to notice or wish they didn't.

Beat.

FROST (CONT'D)
You still wan't me to call you Christina?

CATHY
Dr. Catherine is fine.

FROST
Dr. Catherine then. Thank you for coming, you're doing a good thing.

CATHY
I'm not doing anything yet. I came to hear you out but I have my mom and Dr. Norman on speed dial if you try anything.

FROST
Like what?

CATHY
Anything violent? Kidnapping, shooting, blackmail?

FROST
Cathy, you're an upstanding citizen and a remarkably intelligent self-sufficient woman - you don't have anything in your profile we could use for blackmail.

CATHY
I smoked weed in college.

FROST
So did I. Not blackmail.

CATHY
Can you give me the information I came for? I don't want to be here longer than I have to be.

FROST
We're waiting on one more, but I'll keep it brief...if he ever makes up his mind.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

CATHY
What? Who?

FROST
'64 Pontiac that's been in the parking lot across the street for the past 20 minutes. He's good at what he does; he got here before me. Probably to see if I did anything "shifty" like kidnapping or shooting.

Cathy looks at the parking lot and lowers her glasses to get a better look at: a 1964 Pontiac indeed parked in the lot.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - DAY

Vince is watching Frost and Cathy from his side-view mirror.

He notices Cathy turning to notice his car. Frost waves.

VINCE
(realizing he's been caught)
Son of a bitch...

EXT. TRIO'S DINER - DAY

FROST
Give him a minute, he's skittish.

After a moment - Vince exits the Pontiac wearing almost the exact same outfit as yesterday.

Vince walks over to the diner and sits next to Cathy, opposite Frost.

The waitress comes back and refreshes Frost's espresso.

VINCE
You both look ridiculous.

FROST
You look very professional mister Foresythe, I appreciate that.

VINCE
You look like a well-dressed burglar. You some kind of "smooth criminal"?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FROST
I work for the government, Vincent.

VINCE
So that's a yes.

FROST
Dr. Catherine, meet Vincent Foresythe, he's a local bounty hunter - Vincent, meet Dr. Catherine, she's a biologist - specifically a mycologist. I'm going to be honest, I'm surprised you both showed up. I was worried you wouldn't, but the fact that you did means that this should work out well.

CATHY
Why are we here? Over the phone you told me we'd be helping people.

FROST
Of course, getting to business. You both help people in your own ways - Dr. Catherine, you make advancements in science to try and find what ails people and subsequently, what can heal them. Vincent, you find people - sometimes they're going through a hard time and sometimes they're just flat bad. Either way, you dole out justice. We need both of those for a very bizarre case.

Frost points to the picture of Jessica on the newspaper.

VINCE
I heard about her. Crashed into some rocks drunk driving. Poor kid; stupid kid.

FROST
Jessica Amon. Deceased, 100%. Body confirmed by several professionals on scene, in the autopsy, at the funeral home, and at the funeral.

CATHY
Doesn't sound like a case. Or bizarre, just tragic.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FROST
Of course, the death of Jessica Amon is just that - regular and tragic.

Frost pulls out a manilla folder with a picture of a triangle in a circle on it.

FROST (CONT'D)
The death of Keith Rent is bizarre because Jessica Amon was bursting out of his guts - killing them both.

Vince and Cathy both look up from the manilla folder to process Frost's words.

Frost sips his espresso.

Cathy and Vince look at each other then back to frost.

VINCE
Elaborate.

FROST
Jessica is dead and buried in Bulmont Cemetary 5 miles from here. 3 miles away from us now, there is the corpse of a young man - Keith Rent; a friend and classmate of Jessica, who died from internal trauma - likely caused by what we can only assume is a "clone" of Jessica sticking out of his stomach from her waist up. She also did not survive whatever put them in that situation. The parents of Jessica and Keith both know and are both - as you can imagine, are in great distress.

Cathy picks up, opens the manilla folder, and begins to read.

CATHY
How is that possible?

FROST
It's only possibility for being exists in that sweet 1% chance of anomalies that actually occur - which is where we come in.
(MORE)

FROST (CONT'D)
We had a few people take samples and run tests on what we're currently calling "the siamese" and discovered not only a 100% match with Jessica Amon's DNA but traces of Cladosporium, Monilinia, and Cordyceps fumosorosea - your specialty, Dr. Catherine.

CATHY
Blastospores?

FROST
I'm not a scientist but I heard that word tossed around a little.

VINCE
Now what exactly do you want us to do about this?

FROST
I want you to look over the file and get all the information on the case so you know what you're getting into. If you agree to help out then I want you to find out how this happened, why this happened, and if there is a "who" involved, who did it.

CATHY
And what if we don't agree?

FROST
As I said over the phone, we'll find other people with similar skills that we can make do with.

CATHY
And we just...go home? Am I going to have to worry about other masked government agents coming after me?

FROST
Not at all, you just go home and rest easy. I already told you, Dr. Catherine; nobody cares, truly. You can tell your mom and Dr. Norman this story all you want, but do you think they'll really believe it? And what if they do, what can you really do?

Vince takes the file from Cathy and reads it over.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FROST (CONT'D)
Now Vincent, we may have to keep tabs on for a bit, just to make sure you don't try to snoop any deeper than you should on Delta Green.

VINCE
Smart. But you could just tell me everything now; satiate my curiosity - ensure your anonymity.

FROST
There's really not much beyond what you already know. We're a small branch of the government that handles the 1 odd percent of anomalies that occur around the Americas. Now that 1% is small but important - but the government only cares about the "small" detail, meaning we only have so many specialists at our disposal - which is when we look to the best of the best in their field of expertise. Most are only called up once, maybe twice in their lives, and then never have to worry about us again. Just like the two of you.

VINCE
Good enough.

FROST
You want an address and social security number?

VINCE
I said it was good enough.

FROST
I'll let you both peruse the full case file and make up your mind. It's about 15 til noon, so make your decision before then, please.

Frost picks the newspaper back up and begins doing the crossword.

CATHY
Are you just going to sit there waiting for our answer?

FROST
Pretend I'm not here.

Beat.

CATHY
(to Vince)
What do you think?

VINCE
I think it's batshit insane.

CATHY
I do too.

VINCE
So we say no, right?

CATHY
No.

VINCE
Are you saying no, or are you saying we should say yes?

CATHY
Well, he said if we say "no", then they'd find people who would "make do".

VINCE
Exactly, it doesn't have to be our problem.

CATHY
In my lab we only have so many biologists at our disposal. If one of us is occupied and we pass it off to the "next best person", who is also busy and is also occupied, but they do it anyway - as quickly and sloppily as possible so they can get back to their work.

VINCE
Are you saying we *won't* do that?

CATHY
I'm saying we get first say if that happens or not. If we say "yes" we can at least try not to fuck the whole thing up. The "next best people" always fuck it up.

WRITTEN WORK OF COLIN GRAY

VINCE
All due respect, it sounds like there isn't really any way to fuck this up, Dr. Catherine. 1% of things like this happening, who's to say how things like this should be handled?

CATHY
For starters, we can.

VINCE
Why are *you* so eager to do this? I thought you'd be jumping in your car and speeding away as soon as he tossed up the offer to deliberate.

CATHY
I've made my decision. I want to help, and I know I can do this *right*. "With great power comes great responsibility".

VINCE
Who said that, was that Churchill or is that just you?

FROST
If I may re-enter the conversation for a brief moment; you will both be granted a generous stipend from Delta Green for your efforts - whether you deliver or not. Like a "participation trophy".

VINCE
How much?

FROST
$10,000, untaxable.

VINCE
Split?

FROST
Each.

Cathy and Vince raise their eyebrows in surprise.

VINCE
How long will this take?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FROST
24-48 hours. Dr. Catherine, we'll contact your employers and tell them you're temporarily ill and are taking some sick leave.

Cathy looks back to Vince, who is still rallying from the $10,000.

CATHY
I already made up my mind - based on my morals, but the stipend is a big bonus for me. How about you, was that the extra push you needed?

VINCE
Seems like it. I'll do it.

CATHY
Me too.

FROST
You have just made my day.

Frost reaches into his briefcase and pulls out another package - identical to the ones delivered to Vince and Catherine the previous night.

He slides the package over to them.

FROST (CONT'D)
2 burner phones with the only lines you'll need on speed-dial. 1, 2, and 111. You get to decide who's 1 and who's 2, but you call 111 if you need to contact me.

CATHY
Why would we need to contact you?

FROST
At the end of the mission I'll give you a location to drop a mission brief and any samples you collect off at. I'm also available if anything goes wrong and you need help or backup.

CATHY
Do things go wrong often?

FROST
It's hard to accurately discern "often" within a 1% margin.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

Cathy nods warily.

Frost folds up his newspaper, rummages up his briefcase, and sets $50 cash on the table before standing up.

FROST (CONT'D)
Both of you, get some coffee and a croissant sandwich, they've got good ones here. On my dime. Your first stop is on the 2nd page of the brief - 4429 Jackson Avenue, "Keystone Morgue". You'll be meeting with Freddie in the ice box. Any questions?

VINCE
Where will you be?

FROST
Around.

VINCE
Figures.

CATHY
What's at the "ice box"?

INT. KEYSTONE MORGUE - DAY

Vince, Cathy, and FREDDIE, a middle-aged gentleman with a receding hairline, square glasses, and a lab coat over a fine vest stand (wearing latex gloves) before a pulled out metal gurney displaying:

The dead body of Keith Rent - with indeed, the folded over upper half of Jessica Amon bursting from the stomach of Keith, also deceased.

Both bodies are nude, pale, and grotesque.

Cathy finds the nearest trash can and vomits.

FREDDIE
Yeah...don't feel bad, you're not the first to have that reaction. This is my job and this even made me feel queasy.

VINCE
Can I touch it?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FREDDIE
Gently, just to avoid bruising, breaking any skin, or damaging any tissue.

VINCE
Right.

Vince inspects the body as a whole - lightly poking and prodding around the stomach and the arms. As he does so he notices:

A fresh needle hole in the inner elbow of Keith's left arm.

VINCE (CONT'D)
What's this here?

FREDDIE
Needle mark, not necessarily unusual. We see it a lot in junkies, but Mr. Rent was clean when we scanned. Also possibly a vaccine shot.

VINCE
Looks pretty fresh for a vaccine shot.

FREDDIE
(shrugs)
We didn't pick anything up from that area other than the usual blastospore reading we got from the other blood samples.

Vince begins his inspection around Keith's stomach, looking at the area between him and Jessica.

VINCE
Alright, we know spores and internal trauma, right? Anything else?

FREDDIE
That's really it. It's like she grew out of there.

VINCE
Like a seed?

FREDDIE
As far as the autopsy team could tell.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONOR WRAY

VINCE
Were you on that team?

FREDDIE
No, I'm more of a chaperone/manager.

VINCE
Do you have the autopsy report we could look over?

FREDDIE
Yeah, let me get it.

Freddie walks off to a nearby desk as Cathy returns - her stomach settled.

VINCE
You alright?

CATHY
Yeah, just a strong first impression.

VINCE
Absolutely. You hear what our man Fred says about her growing like a seed out of Mr. Rent here?

CATHY
Yeah. You mind if I take a look?

VINCE
All yours.

Cathy replaces Vince in inspecting Keith's stomach.

As she pushes and pokes the corpse, she sees that there are several segments **where the flesh between Jessica and Keith are connected.**

CATHY
Found something that knocks the "seed theory" a bit. Look here, where the flesh connects.

Cathy points to a few different points where the flesh blends together.

CATHY (CONT'D)
Here, and here too. Like one body.

VINCE
What does that mean?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

CATHY
I'm not sure yet, but I have a growing theory. Freddie can I see the autopsy report?

Freddie hands Cathy the report. She flips through it.

She reads through the segment on height and weight -

Height: 6'3

Weight: 265lbs.

CATHY (CONT'D)
Freddie, do you know how heavy Keith and Jessica were when they were...normal?

FREDDIE
I don't but their insurance was used for the same doctor, it's only a block away. They can give you the reports.

VINCE
They wouldn't just give us the reports.

FREDDIE
Well, if you flash your Fed IDs they would.

CATHY
Our what?

Freddie looks at them both, confused.

FREDDIE
You guys are Delta Green, right?

VINCE
Associates, yeah.

FREDDIE
You guys were given a folder - did you look all the way through it?

CATHY
I thought so.

FREDDIE
Well, give it another once over when you get to your car.
(MORE)

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

FREDDIE (CONT'D)
You can take the autopsy report, I have a copy. You're looking for St. Jude Medical, Dr. Stane's office.

VINCE
Much appreciated, Freddie.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - DAY

Cathy is flipping through the manilla folder given to them over brunch by Frost.

Between the last and second-to-last pages of briefing, there is a small plastic bag containing 2 F.B.I. IDs with Cathy and Vince's names and pictures on them.

Cathy holds them up for Vince to see.

CATHY
How the hell did they do that?

VINCE
Looks like they've got a few tabs on our previous jobs. That picture of me was used on a keycard I used to get into granddaughters school when I'd help build sets for her schools theater. That was a few years ago now.

Cathy looks at her ID and takes out her own lanyard badge for Binary Labs. It's the same picture.

CATHY
Son of a bitch. You've got really good eyes.

VINCE
For an old guy.

CATHY
I didn't mean it like that.

VINCE
Nah, I'm just busting your balls. Where's this St. Jude Medical?

Cathy pulls a local map out of the folder and looks it over for a moment.

She then looks up and down the left side of the street before pointing at: St. Jude Medical Center about a quarter mile down the road.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

VINCE (CONT'D)
Huh, I don't know how I missed that. Maybe I should get my eyes checked after all.

The two drive over.

INT. ST. JUDE'S MEDICAL CENTER - DAY

Vince and Cathy walk up to the front desk where a woman in scrubs is operating a desktop monitor.

NURSE
Hi, welcome in. What can I do for you today?

Vince looks at Cathy who is noticeably tense and uncomfortable.

VINCE
Uh, we're here to get some copies on the latest physical examinations for one Jessica Amon and...Keith Rent. I believe they were patients of Dr. Stang.

CATHY
(correcting)
Stane.

VINCE
Dr. Stane.

NURSE
(apologetically)
I'm afraid all patient details are confidential.

Beat.

Vince looks back to Cathy awkwardly before reaching into his jacket pocket and pulling out his FED I.D.

VINCE
Uhm...how about this, then?

NURSE
Oh, you're with the government?

VINCE
...Yep.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

NURSE
Right, sorry about that. I'll tell Dr. Stane to print out some copies, it'll take a few minutes, please make yourselves comfortable.

The nurse rises from her seat and walks to the back offices.

Vince and Cathy sit in the waiting lobby.

VINCE
What's wrong with you, are you going to throw up again?

CATHY
No, but this is just so weird. This is "James Bond" stuff we're doing - we're not FBI.

VINCE
Ok, say that a little quieter.

CATHY
(whispering)
Lying about being in government is illegal right?

VINCE
It can be.

CATHY
But the way we're doing it, Vince...it's *very* illegal, right?

VINCE
I don't know. We are employed by the government technically, so it's a gray area I suppose.

CATHY
How gray? What if someone finds out?

VINCE
If anyone finds out we throw Frost and Delta Green under the bus. That's what everybody wants, "the head of the operation".

CATHY
Yeah, but Vince, it seems like Delta Green's whole thing is not being found out.
(MORE)

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

CATHY (CONT'D)
Do you think they'd come bail us out if we get caught?

Vince stops to consider.

VINCE
Maybe we hustle out of here really quick after we get those reports.

CATHY
Yes, let's.

The nurse comes back out with a few sheets of paper and hands them to Vince.

NURSE
Here we go, Ms. Amon and Mr. Rent as requested...tragedy what happened to Ms. Amon, really.

VINCE
Yeah, it really is.

Vince and Cathy stand up and rush to the door. Vince is holding the door outside open when Cathy stops and turns to the nurse.

CATHY
What about Mr. Rent?

The nurse tilts her head.

NURSE
What about him?

Cathy realizes - she doesn't know Keith is dead. Likely, few other people beyond his parents do either.

CATHY
Nevermind, thank you.

Cathy and Vince rush out to the car in the driveway and speed away.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - DAY

CATHY
She didn't know.

VINCE
What?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

CATHY
She doesn't know Keith is dead.

VINCE
Why does that matter? She just works there.

CATHY
Well what if Dr. Stane doesn't know either? What if his teachers or his boss don't know? What about his friends?

VINCE
You can't get lost in "what if's", they're a bottomless well, Doctor. His people may not know, not now. But there's only so much time that can pass before they realize he's gone.

CATHY
But are they going to be told the truth?

VINCE
Do you think they should be? Do you think that's what they want to remember their friend as?

Cathy goes quiet for a bit as they drive.

CATHY
After years of talk and theory and discourse, Galileo told everyone that the earth wasn't the center of our system, it was the sun. A lot of people got upset, a lot more discourse came about, but now it's just common knowledge. The hard truth is important - even if it flips your whole world upside-down.

Vince nods, understanding - not necessarily agreeing.

VINCE
Regardless, that's not our call to make. What did you need those reports for?

CATHY
To give my theory a few more legs to stand on.

Cathy looks at the separate files, checking height and weight:

Keith = 6'3 / 220lbs

Jessica = 5'9 / 130lbs

VINCE
And?

CATHY
Just got some legs. The siamese was 265 pounds in weight. Keith alone was 220 as of 2 months ago, Jessica was 130 pounds as of 1 month ago.

VINCE
What does that mean?

CATHY
If "seed theory" were true the siamese would be about 285 pounds, half of Jessica and all of Keith, but it's not. It means this isn't a seed growing out of a man, it's a parasite taking from a host to give itself form. Hence the weight loss and the skin blending.

Vince grimaces in disgust at the idea.

VINCE
Good lord, that's brutal. Why didn't the Jessica parasite take over all of Keith then?

Cathy ponders for a moment - she comes up empty.

CATHY
I'm not sure.

VINCE
You'll figure it out. Where are we going now?

CATHY
There are a couple of people we could look into at Jessica's college: Samson University. Looks like one of them has a house near campus and the other dorms. Hailey Moore and Evan Breen.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

VINCE
We should start with the house first, should be easier to get into.

CATHY
You think so.

VINCE
Usually is. Kids their age usually are living with other dumb kids who roll over for people our age or their parents who roll over to the badges we've got.

CATHY
Saying "our age" is a broad stretch.

VINCE
What, how old are you, 41?

Cathy slowly turns to look at him, insulted.

VINCE (CONT'D)
(clueless)
Too high? 39?

Cathy shakes her head.

VINCE (CONT'D)
I'll figure it out.

They drive off to the university.

EXT. HAILEY'S HOUSE - EVENING

The sun is getting low and the sky is getting dark. Thunder rumbles overhead as dark gray clouds move in.

Vince parks the car a good several rows down the street from Hailey's house.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - EVENING

VINCE
Alright. We need a game plan.

CATHY
What, why do we need a game plan? What game are we planning for?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

VINCE
Contact sports, if I had to bet.

Vince reaches over to the glove box and pulls out **1 of 2 6-shot snubnose revolvers, leaving the other in the glove box sitting on top of a phonebook.**

Cathy's eyes go wide.

CATHY
WOAH - we've skipped over some levels of escalation! Why do you need that?

Vince checks the barrel - it's full.

VINCE
You ever eat at Beach Shack burger?

CATHY
No.

VINCE
Don't. When I ate there in '83, I got a bad stomach parasite. I was shitting my guts out bad for a week, lost a lot of weight, sure. Not worth the damage, I'd say.

CATHY
Why is this relevant?

VINCE
You said the siamese was "parasitic".

CATHY
Yeah, one fed off the other.

VINCE
Right. It also means that our young man Keith ingested that parasite somehow. I'm willing to bet there's not many places serving up "blastospore burgers" in the area, am I right?

CATHY
(catching on)
Yeah..?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONOR WRAY

VINCE
Which means our aspiring student either stumbled into some terribly contaminated water - or...

CATHY
Somebody put the blastospores in him.

VINCE
There was a needle mark on Keith's left arm. I'm willing to bet they injected him with some parasite-spore cocktail.

CATHY
Shit...

VINCE
You ever use one of these?

CATHY
No - and I'm not going to. We're dealing with college kids.

VINCE
Well you're not using this one, this is mine. Yours is in the glove box just in case.

CATHY
Vince, I'm not using a gun.

VINCE
Not every shot is a lethal one, Doctor, you just need to know where to aim. Arms, thighs, calves. Fatty places that can take it.

CATHY
I'm not trained in firearms, Vince - I'm not shooting a gun.

VINCE
And what if the same person who got Keith tries to stick you, huh? Are you going to let them? Cause I'll tell you now, I'm not letting them get me. And you're a smart person - a good person. You've got more to give than one crazy kid.

Beat.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

CATHY
You do the shooting, only if it comes to it.

VINCE
Only if it comes to it.

CATHY
So, what's our gameplan?

VINCE
I'll go up and lead with the whole "FBI" gimmick - doing a wellness check or something. Whatever the FBI does. Then, if it gets heated, I pull out the heater and tell them they're under arrest.

CATHY
Do you have handcuffs?

VINCE
I've got zipties.

CATHY
Right, bounty hunter.

VINCE
If that doesn't work - leg shot.

Cathy gets quiet at the idea of shooting.

Vince notices and eases up.

VINCE (CONT'D)
This is all worst-case-scenario, Doctor. More likely, I go in and have a short chat with a friend in distress and we move on to the dorm kid.

CATHY
What do I do during all this?

VINCE
You stay in the car, keep it running. If all goes well, we drive to the dorms and talk to this Evan kid. If things go south, you drive quick to a police station. While I'm working everything out inside, you can check the map to find out where the closest one is.

CATHY
(nodding)
I can do that.

VINCE
I know you can. You need to go over it again?

Cathy looks at Hailey's house. Thunder rumbles louder again and soft rain begins to sprinkle down.

CATHY
No, I've got it. You handle Hailey, I'll keep the car running and find the nearest precinct.

VINCE
And see if you can cook up any more theories on why the Jessica parasite didn't take for Keith.

CATHY
Right, that too. You have your phone on your?

VINCE
I do. I'm 2, you're 1. Ready?

CATHY
Ready.

Vince holds out his hand for Cathy to shake. She does.

Vince gets out of the car - the headlights illuminating the rain as it steadily picks up. He tucks his snubnose into his jacket pocket and walks to the house.

Cathy pulls up the manilla folder and flips to the brief on Hailey Moore:

Intramural volleyball player

Majoring in earth sciences

Certificates in communications

Nothing on height or weight.

Cathy huffs in disappointment, then opens the glove box to reveal the other pistol and the phone book.

She puts the gun in the passenger seat and pulls out the phone book, quickly finding: Dr. Stane's office at St. Jude Medical Center.

Cathy dials the number and after a few rings:

DR. STANE
Dr. Stane's office, who's speaking?

CATHY
Dr. Stane, hi. Sorry to bother you, I'm sure you're ready to get home. Me and my...partner were there earlier today to get files on Jessica Amon and Keith Rent.

DR. STANE
Oh, yes! The uh...agents, right?

CATHY
Right, my name is Agent...Christina, and I was wondering if you possibly had a Ms. Hailey Moore as a patient as well?

DR. STANE
Oh, yes!

EXT. HAILEY'S HOUSE - EVENING

Vince knocks on the front door. No answer for a bit. Vince knocks again.

The door opens to reveal MEGAN MURRAY, Hailey's roommate.

MEGAN
Hello?

VINCE
Hey, sorry to intrude this late. Is there a Hailey Moore living here?

Megan stiffens up.

MEGAN
(making it up as she goes)
Yes, bit she's...really busy right now. She's been kind of burying herself in work, her friend just died...

VINCE
I know, I'm here asking about the friend.

MEGAN
What do you mean?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

Vince pulls out the FBI ID and shows it to her.

VINCE
Can I come in and I can explain?

Megan's eyes go wide.

MEGAN
Y-yeah...can you give me like 2 minutes to clean up, it's really messy inside.

VINCE
I smell the pot, kid, it's fine. I'm not here about that.

Megan's shoulders loosen and she nods, stepping aside to let him in.

MEGAN
Please don't tell my parents.

Vince walks in and wipes his shoes off.

VINCE
What you spend your money on and put in your body is none of my business. Is Hailey really burying herself in work?

MEGAN
No, she's outside smoking.

VINCE
Cigarettes?

Megan shakes her head.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Fair enough. Has she been uh...dealing with any other substances?

MEGAN
Like what? Coke? Hell no.

VINCE
What about blastospores?

MEGAN
What are blasting spores?

Vince takes a minute to respond before realizing:

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

VINCE
I don't know. Look, you mind if I talk to her for a minute? Me and my partner are pit stopping here to see if she can give us any insight on some things that have been going on since her friends passing. It'll be short and then we'll be out to talk some Evan kid.

Megan looks Vince up and down with a look of vague discomfort before nodding.

MEGAN
You'd probably have more luck with Evan, he's a creep. But yeah, Hailey's out back. Try not to freak her out.

VINCE
(nods)
Thanks. Where's the back door?

MEGAN
Turn left at the end, there's a door in the kitchen.

Vince walks to the kitchen and pauses in the doorway.

VINCE
You're talking about Evan Breen, right?

MEGAN
Yeah, I think that's his name.

VINCE
What makes him so creepy?

MEGAN
He's just a little pervy. He'd show up here - uninvited, and just ask to hang out. I'd always tell him to beat feet, but Hailey always felt bad and let him stay for a while.

VINCE
(nodding)
Anything else?

MEGAN
Not with Hailey. I think he and Jessica had a thing going on but nothing serious.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONOR WRAY

VINCE
What kind of thing?

MEGAN
I don't know, it's not really my business to talk about.

Vince flashes the ID again. Megan sighs.

MEGAN (CONT'D)
Evan was really into Jess - I mean *really* into her. And from what Hailey told me, Jess didn't really feel the same. But she felt bad about flat shutting it down with him, especially since they had some classes together - she didn't want to make it awkward. So she kind of entertained it. They never hooked up or kissed or anything, at least not that I know about.

Vince takes the information in.

VINCE
Evan would drop by unannounced...when Jessica was over, right?

MEGAN
Yeah, pretty much exclusively.

VINCE
Would you say he was a bit of a stalker?

Megan considers for a moment, letting the discomfort sink in. She crosses her arms in front of her chest and nods.

VINCE (CONT'D)
I'm going to talk to Hailey. You've been very helpful.

MEGAN
Ok. No problem.

Vince walks outside and sees a small porch with a small table and 2 chairs. In the middle of the table is a Simpsons ash tray with a half-smoked joint still smoking.

Hailey isn't there.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - NIGHT

Cathy is still on the phone with Dr. Stane.

Cathy pulls up Jessica and Keith's medical file.

DR. STANE
(over the phone)
Ok, I've got the file here.

CATHY
Thank you. Do you mind reading off the height and weight?

DR. STANE
Let's see...Hailey Moore. Height: 5'9, weight: approximately 130lbs.

Cathy compares the numbers Dr. Stane has prattled off to Jessica's sheet. Identical.

Cathy nods, pulls out a pen from her pocket and writes it down next to Jessica's information.

CATHY
Great...Thank you so much Dr. Stane, you've been a big help.

DR. STANE
Of course, I'll be out for the rest of the day but call back tomorrow if there's anything else I can do.

CATHY
Will do, thank you.

Cathy hangs up.

Cathy sits back in the drivers seat and looks at the numbers, comparing Hailey and Jessica to Keith.

CATHY (CONT'D)
It wasn't a compatible host...

EXT. BACK YARD - NIGHT

The yard is empty and wet. Near the back of the house there are 2 trees - one larger, one smaller.

Vince looks around the back yard. It's too dark and the rain has become too strong for him to see anything too far out.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

VINCE
(sharply)
Hailey!

A rustling noise comes from behind the larger tree.

Megan rushes out to him.

MEGAN
What are you doing? You're going to scare her!

VINCE
Do you have a flashlight I can use?

MEGAN
I think so...

Megan checks a junk drawer in her kitchen before finding a crappy pocket flashlight and passing it off to Vince.

Vince clicks the flashlight on and points it to the trees - it just barely reaches. **There is the faintest reflection of flashlight against glasses between the trees. Vince doesn't notice.**

Vince moves closer to the trees, illuminating them more fully. There is no figure visible with glasses.

VINCE
Hailey, I have some questions about Jessica Amon, if you could spare a few minutes for me. I'm with the FBI.

As he approaches, the rustling grows louder. He points the flashlight to the ground to see 2 feet behind the larger tree trembling - seizing.

Vince turns behind the tree and turns his light onto:

Jessica Amon shaking on the floor on her back. Her eyes are bloodshot, there is blood leaking from her nostrils and her veins are bulging out of her forehead, neck, and arms.

VINCE (CONT'D)
What the fuck?

Vince squats down and lays Jessica on her side.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Jessica? Jessica breathe, I need you to breathe. I'll call for help.

Vince pulls out his phone and dials 1.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - NIGHT

Rain hits the windshield violently.

The burner phone rings, Cathy answers.

CATHY
Vince, everything alright?

VINCE
(panicked)
I don't know, I don't know what I'm looking at.

CATHY
Slow down, describe it to me.

CUTTING BACK AND FORTH BETWEEN CATHY AND VINCE.

VINCE
It's...It's Jessica, it's the kid. She looks really...sick, or something. She looks bad, but it's her. And she's alive.

Vince looks up at Megan who has stepped out into the rain on the porch.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Call 911 - tell them your friend is having a seizure and to send an ambulance!

Megans eyes widen and she runs inside.

CATHY
What? You're sure?

Jessica wheezes, getting air into her lungs and appearing more cognizant - but still shaking.

VINCE
I'm sure.

CATHY
Did you find Hailey?

VINCE
No, I didn't find her. I think she might be our culprit.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

Cathy connects the dots.

CATHY
Vince, that's not Jessica.

VINCE
What?

Jessica wheezes and coughs out a lump of bile before looking up at Vince. She tries to speak a few times but chokes on her words.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Easy, one word at a time. Breathe deep between each.

JESSICA
(wheezing)
I...am.....not.......Jessica.....

Vince furrows his brow - confused.

CATHY
Vince! That's Hailey! The blastospores worked, you're talking to Hailey!

Vince's eyes widen and he looks back to Jessica/Hailey.

VINCE
Hailey?

She slowly pulls a shaking hand up and points a finger to herself, nodding.

VINCE (CONT'D)
What happened?

Hailey's finger drifts over to the second tree.

Vince looks up and shines the flashlight to the tree where we see:

A disgruntled EVAN BREEN soaking wet, his scrawny frame gripping into the narrow tree, one hand still holding an empty syringe. His pupils behind his glasses are illuminated like a wild animals. He is breathing feverishly.

Vince is frozen. He's looking at an incredibly intelligent animal.

CATHY
Vince, what's going on?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

Vince breaks free from his spell and pulls his revolver.

VINCE
Stay where you are!

Evan sprits off around the corner of the un-fenced back yard.

Vince fires a shot near his leg - hitting only dirt.

VINCE (CONT'D)
(over the phone)
DOCTOR, CATHERINE IT'S EVAN! HE'S GOT A SYRINGE, IT'S HIM! IT'S FUCKING BREEN!

INT. VINCE'S CAR - NIGHT

Cathy hears Vince's words and her eyes widen as she looks up to see Evan **running out from the back yard to the street, narrowly dodging a passing car.**

VINCE
(over the phone)
HE'S GOING FRONT! WAIT FOR ME!

CATHY
(panicking)
Ok...ok...

Cathy's eyes stay on Evan as he rushes to a scrappy blue car from 1982, unlocks it and **starts the engine.**

CATHY (CONT'D)
Vince. Vince he's in a car.

EXT. BACK YARD - NIGHT

Vince sits Hailey up against the tree and stands.

VINCE
Wait for me!

Hailey grabs Vince's wrist. Vince looks down to see Hailey's eyes crying tears down Jessica's cheeks in the rain.

HAILEY
What did he do to me...?

VINCE
I...I need to go!

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

INT. VINCE'S CAR - NIGHT

Evan turns the car out of the parking spot.

CATHY
He's getting out of the space, Vince, he's going to run.

VINCE
Fuck!

CATHY
What do I do, Vince? What's the game plan for this?

VINCE
I-I don't know, give me a second!

CATHY
We don't have a second!

Evan pulls the car out and drives away down the street.

CATHY (CONT'D)
He's going.

Cathy shifts gears into drive with a shuddering breath.

VINCE
Wait!

CATHY
I'm going, stay with Hailey!

EXT. HAILEY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy speeds off, in hot pursuit of Evan.

As she darts off turning a corner - Vince rushes out of the back yard to see the tail lights of his car speeding away from him.

VINCE
FUCK!

Megan runs out onto the front porch.

MEGAN
What's happening?!

Vince looks back up the street to see ambulance and police lights approaching.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

Vince looks back to Megan.

VINCE
Do you have a car?

Megan nods.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Keys!

EXT. HIGHWAY - NIGHT

Evan is speeding recklessly down the highway. The roads are slick and the few cars on the road honk at him as he bobs and weaves between the vehicles.

Cathy has the windshield wipers on full strength but it's barely enough to see the cars ahead of her.

She finesses her way out from behind a Ford to get next to Evan's blue car.

Evan notices her and speeds ahead.

Cathy follows closely behind.

CATHY
(to herself)
Shit shit shit....

Evan speeds up as far as he can before he is caught behind semi-trucks taking up the road ahead.

Cathy is stationed only about 10 feet behind him.

In a desperate snap judgement - **Evan hits the breaks**. His car skirts in the rain and slows.

Cathy hits the breaks as fast as she can and turns her car out of the way but the **left headlight hits the right tail light of Evan's car. Cathy's car skirts out in the highway as cars behind them slow and honk their horns.**

Evan notices a **dirt road ahead, beyond the semi's.**

He hits the gas and flies his car off the pavement and onto bumpy grassy muddy turf that he drives along only for a few seconds before turning left onto the dirt road.

Cathy quickly checks herself - only a small cut on her forehead from her head hitting the steering wheel. Not enough for the airbag to go off.

She corrects the car and dashes after Evan onto the dirt road.

As she turns onto the dirt she finds the inevitable, illuminated by headlights:

Evan's car crashed into a tree.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - NIGHT

Cathy pulls the car up behind the crash and parks, leaving the engine running.

She catches her breath as she waits to see if Evan makes a move. If he can move.

Nothing from the car before her.

Cathy turns her head to the passenger seat. **The pistol**.

She bites her lip, wrestling with choice.

She takes the gun - checks the ammo. It spills out onto her lap.

She quietly curses herself and puts the bullets into the barrel with shaking hands.

Once they're all in, she clasps it shut and holds it tight with both hands.

She takes a few deep calming breaths. Still no movement from Evan.

EXT. DIRT ROAD - NIGHT

Cathy exits the car and holds the pistol out with both hands. Rain beats both cars and the mud beneath her shoes.

She slowly approaches Evan's car.

CATHY
My name is...Agent Christina! I'm with the FBI! I'm here regarding the case of Jessica Amon and Keith Rent...Evan Breen, I'm going to need you to exit the vehicle!

No movement from the car.

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Cathy inches closer and sees as she approaches: the damage is not terrible. The airbag went off but has deflated. She doesn't see Evan in the drivers seat.

CATHY (CONT'D)
(mutters)
Fuck...

She steels herself.

CATHY (CONT'D)
Evan Breen, please exit the vehicle or I will need to take you in...by force. I'll have you know, *I am armed!* And I don't want to use it but I *will* if I have to!

Cathy edges closer to the car, getting closer to the drivers window.

CATHY (CONT'D)
(pleading)
Don't make me use it...

Cathy fully turns to the drivers seat window and points the gun in to see:

Evan Breen hunkered in the passenger seat in a crouched position, clutching a half-full syringe of orange liquid in one hand. He is manic and desperate.

Cathy and Evan both freeze.

CATHY (CONT'D)
(yelling)
I'M AGENT CATHY PRENNICK, PUT THE SYRINGE DOWN NOW OR I WILL SHO-

Evan lunges with the syringe.

In a hairsplitting second, Cathy aims for his arm and fires.

BANG!

The gun smokes and Cathy looks into the car to see:

Evan slumped in the car awkwardly, his syringe holding arm hanging limply out of the drivers seat window - a bullet hole in his forehead. Blood from the wound has splattered on the white airbag.

Cathy shudders and drops the gun.

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She instinctually reaches her hands out to try and help, but pulls them back in when she realizes it's too late.

She stumbles for words but is lost.

CATHY (CONT'D)
I'm...I'm sorry - I'm so sorry...I'm so so sorry, I didn't mean - I was aiming - I thought I was aiming...oh fuck, *fuck!*

Cathy falls to the ground in the rain and begins sobbing.

CATHY (CONT'D)
WHY DID YOU MAKE ME DO THIS!?

EXT. HIGHWAY - NIGHT

Vince cruises down the street in a dark red modern car. He sees the debris of the headlights on the street and tire tracks in the mud leading off to a dirt road.

Vince turns the car onto the dirt road and pulls in next to his car - his headlights illuminate a heaving Cathy.

EXT. DIRT ROAD - NIGHT

Vince exits the car and rushes to Cathy.

VINCE
What happened? What happened, tell me?

He notices the pistol on the ground - **next to a syringe**.

Cathy looks up at him, tears in her eyes.

CATHY
We said it would be you! You would do it! You said that was the plan!

Vince rises to his feet and looks into Evan's car, seeing the corpse.

VINCE
God...

Vince looks down at Cathy and shakes her shoulders.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Hey...hey, tell me what happened. You have to tell me.

Cathy inhales shaky breaths and halts her sobs before answering as calmly as possible.

CATHY
I told him to get out. I told him to get out and that I was armed - and that I would use it...I walked to his car and I saw him just...hunched over with a syringe and I told him - I *told him to put it down!* And he didn't! He jumped at me and I shot! I aimed for his arm and I...I missed. I missed, Vince, I killed him.

VINCE
(nods)
You killed him, but he was going to kill you. You didn't have a choice.

CATHY
(shaking her head)
No, I had a choice...I had a choice, Vince, I didn't have to kill him.

VINCE
You weren't trying to - but you did. He *was* trying to kill you, and you stopped him. He killed Keith, he almost killed Hailey - he would've killed you too. You stopped a bad person.

CATHY
He's a *fucking KID,* Vince!

VINCE
He's old enough to make his own choices, and he made them. He just made too many bad ones.

CATHY
I didn't have to do it...I tried to do it the right way - I said we wouldn't fuck it up - *I said that!*

VINCE
Doctor, we can talk about this later - we need to call Frost and wrap this up. We need to go.
(MORE)

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VINCE (CONT'D)
The cops arrived at Hailey's, I took her roommates car and unless Frost has some backup plans, they'll be after us soon. Get in my car, We'll work this out.

Cathy, in shock, nods and rises to her feet.

Vince picks up the **pistol and the syringe** before walking back to his car.

INT. VINCE'S CAR - NIGHT

Cathy gets in the passenger seat, Vince gets in the drivers seat and sets the pistol in the back seat and the syringe on the dash board.

The rain patters on the roof. Cathy looks ahead at the limp arm of Evan hanging out of the driver's window - still lit up by the headlights.

Vince turns the headlights off - killing the image. He looks to Cathy, covered in muck and rain.

VINCE
How did you know it wasn't Jessica?

CATHY
(slowly)
Jessica is dead...but her medical sheet said she was a blood donor. And Hailey's sheet said her height and weight matched Jessica's perfectly. The parasite...the blastospores needed a host with just about identical form so it could reshape itself. Too much and it gets confused on where to go and crushes itself - too little and it has no where to go and overstretches the figure. The hosts conditions need to be just right...

VINCE
And Hailey's were?

Cathy nods quietly.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Is she going to be ok? Can they turn her back?

CATHY
I don't know...if they're comfortable and capable of recreating a similar serum with Hailey's DNA. That's assuming her body won't collapse from shock and the formula is stable...and a million other factors that come with mysterious formula.

VINCE
So she'll just look like that forever?

CATHY
Unfortunately...I think so.

Vince and Cathy are quiet for a moment.

CATHY (CONT'D)
Drive away, please.

Vince nods and turns the car on. He puts the syringe in the cup holder and pulls away from the dirt road and gets back onto the highway.

VINCE
Can you call Frost?

Cathy opens her burner and dials 111.

The phone rings for a bit. No answer.

Cathy looks at the phone to see if that happened - it did.

CATHY
He didn't pick up.

VINCE
(in disbelief)
Try again.

Cathy dials 111 again. After a few rings:

FROST
(over the phone)
Hello?

CATHY
Frost. It's Dr. Catherine.

FROST
Evening, Doctor. How's the mission, any troubles?

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CATHY
(shakily)
It's...it's done. It was a formula of parasitic blastospores...I didn't learn the recipe for it but...Evan Breen was the culprit. He, uh...he got Hailey Moore. I don't know if she'll live, but she got...*changed*, into Jessica. It sounds like only physically, but I don't know.

Beat.

CATHY (CONT'D)
Are you there?

FROST
And Evan?

CATHY
Dead.

FROST
Body?

VINCE
(chiming in)
Dirt road a couple miles off of I-35.

CATHY
Dirt road a couple miles off of I-35.

FROST
We'll send a cleanup crew. Do you have any evidence or materials to drop off?

CATHY
A syringe.

FROST
With the formula?

CATHY
Yeah.

FROST
Ok, good. There's a couple notecards in the manilla folder. I'll need both of you to write a short debrief on the mission.
(MORE)

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FROST (CONT'D)
I'll send you the coordinates on where to drop the briefs and the syringe.

CATHY
Ok.

The line goes dead.

Coordinates appear on Cathy's phone.

She scans the map from the manilla folder and finds them - near an old gas station.

EXT. GAS STATION - NIGHT

Vince's car pulls into the back of a lonely gas station off the highway. The only other car being an unseen employee inside.

Cathy double checks the coordinates. This is it.

Inside Vince's car - Vince finishes writing his brief.

VINCE
All done. You?

CATHY
All done.

VINCE
I'll drop it all off.

CATHY
Where?

Vince points ahead to a nearby green dumpster that has **the triangle within a circle graffiti'd on it.**

Cathy nods.

Vince takes Cathy's brief and the syringe - exits the car, and walks to the dumpster. Under the Delta Green symbol he sees a small hatch connected to the side of the dumpster. He opens it up - a small cache hole with 2 envelopes inside labeled: Prennick & Foresythe.

Vince takes the envelopes and drops the 3 items in the cache and returns to the car.

Vince returns to the car and hands Cathy her envelope.

CATHY (CONT'D)
What's this?

VINCE
Not sure, it was just in there.

They both open the envelopes to find:

A government check made out to each of them for $10,000.

Cathy lets out a single somber laugh.

VINCE (CONT'D)
Hey, they weren't lying.

CATHY
No...let's hope not.

VINCE
What's the plan now?

Cathy sighs and dials 111 again.

The line picks up.

FROST
Agents?

CATHY
It's dropped off. We got the money.

FROST
Good job. You did good work today. Some families will be able to rest a bit easier soon. Thank you both.

Beat.

CATHY
What now?

FROST
Now, you go home. You did your jobs. We'll take it from here. You never have to worry about us again.

Click. The line goes out.

Cathy sets the phone down.

CATHY
We go home.

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INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

The front door opens slowly to sprinkling rain, significantly subsided from earlier. Cathy stands in the doorway a moment before walking into her home and shutting the door behind her.

She walks past her fridge, beyond her living room, to the bathroom.

She turns on the faucet and lets shower water run.

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Vince sets his keys on the table before making his way to the bedroom. He removes his clothes and tosses them into a hamper before changing into a plain white shirt and plaid pajama pants.

He then walks out and moves to his wet bar.

He grabs himself a glass and a bottle of whiskey. He pours himself 2 fingers - pauses - then adds a third.

He drops ice in the glass and sits on a recliner in his living room. Slowly, quietly, he sips from the drink in the dark room.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy is showering - scrubbing the mud and gunk from her arms, her legs, and her hair. As she scrubs, flecks of red drip down into the drain - blood from Evan she didn't realize had made it onto her in the dark.

She shuts her eyes tight and grips her hair tightly in her hands, trying to keep her breathing steady.

INT. VINCE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Vince gets settled into bed and flicks off his bedside lamp.

He tucks himself under his blanket and stares up at the ceiling.

He releases one big sigh and shuts his eyes before falling asleep - letting out gentle snores.

INT. CATHY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Cathy sits on her bed wrapped in a towel, her head in her hands, no lights on.

She gets changed into a long sleeve shirt and basketball shorts and gets settled into bed.

She stares up at the ceiling and does her deep breath exercises.

She breathes deeply in - and releases.

She repeats.

She shuts her eyes and repeats.

As she repeats again, a tear slips out of her shut eye as her breath begins to shake.

She repeats again.

And again. Another tear that she quickly wipes away.

After a beat, she gives up.

Her eyes open. She is not tired. She will not sleep. She cannot sleep.

THE END.

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